

RAZAK AZEEZ

Assistant Manager – Audit & Financial Reporting

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[linkedin.com/in/razak-azeez](https://www.linkedin.com/in/razak-azeez) | Right to work (UK): No sponsorship required

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

ACCA-qualified audit and financial reporting specialist with 10+ years leading IFRS and regulatory audit assignments for FTSE 100 insurers, public sector, and consumer product clients. Proven record guiding cross-border teams (UK, Ghana, Saudi Arabia) to enhance controls and drive high-quality audit delivery under PwC, EY, and WTS. Strong technical proficiency in IFRS 17, Solvency II, and ISA audits, complemented by analytics-driven reviews using Aura, Helix, and Alteryx. Focused on efficiency, collaboration, and delivering meaningful insights to stakeholders.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Optimised financial close processes by 20% through reconciliation automation and control redesign.
- Delivered multiple FTSE 100 insurance audits (Aviva, Brit, FIL Life) with consistent clean audit opinions.
- Managed multi-country audit teams (up to 8 auditors) and reduced review points by 20% through targeted coaching.
- Achieved 10% under-budget completion rates on SME audit portfolio with zero compliance issues.
- Supported IFRS 17 implementation and transitioned insurer reporting under Solvency II frameworks.

CORE SKILLS

Technical: IFRS 17 - Solvency II - IFRS / UK GAAP - ISA / AICPA - Actuarial liaison - Data analytics - Regulatory compliance

Leadership: Team management - Stakeholder engagement - Budgeting - Coaching - Audit quality review - Process improvement

Tools: PwC Aura - EY Helix - Alteryx - Excel (Advanced) - ERPs (Sun System, Exergy, Soft Act)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Assistant Manager | WTS Limited | Remote | Sep 2024 – Present

- Lead end-to-end statutory audits for SMEs, from planning through IFRS-compliant financial statements.
- Eliminated GHS 100K reconciliation discrepancies and reduced monthly close by 20%.
- Managed five client audits, completing each 10% under budget with zero compliance exceptions.
- Partnered with CFOs and FDs throughout planning, interim reviews, and close-out phases.
- Mentored three junior auditors, improving documentation quality and cutting review points by 20%.

Senior Associate | PwC LLP | London, UK | Feb 2023 – May 2024

- Delivered IFRS 17 and UK GAAP audits for FTSE 100 insurers (Aviva, Brit, FIL Life) using Aura.
- Executed planning 15% ahead of schedule; identified control gaps and led targeted remediation.
- Conducted risk assessments, fraud/going concern testing (ISA-compliant) and reporting reviews.
- Reviewed disclosures and audit reports for partner and executive-level communications.
- Contributed to IFRS 17 transition assurance including opening balance validation for Brit Insurance.

Assistant Manager | EY LLP | Ghana / Saudi Arabia | Oct 2020 – Jan 2023

- Oversaw group and statutory audits across insurance, manufacturing, and public sector clients under EY GAM.
- Directed audit planning, fieldwork, and closure meetings with minimal partner supervision.
- Collaborated with actuarial teams to challenge reserves and test liability assumptions.
- Enhanced governance, IT, and internal control processes, identifying efficiency and upsell opportunities.
- Supervised teams of up to eight members, boosting team performance and engagement.

Audit Senior | EY LLP | Accra, Ghana | Oct 2013 – Sep 2020

- Led full audit cycles across insurance, public, and not-for-profit clients under IFRS.
- Reduced year-end adjustments by 45% through strengthened control and reporting processes.
- Tested revenue recognition, payroll, tax, and asset controls, helping clients resolve audit queries promptly.
- Reviewed deferred tax computations, VAT reconciliations, and IFRS 12 disclosures.
- Regularly facilitated planning and risk workshops to align engagement scope with client priorities.
- Leveraged helix for 30% faster anomaly detection.

KEY CLIENTS

Aviva plc - Brit Insurance - FIL Life - Ghana Cocoa Board - Riyadh International Catering Co. - National Advanced Systems (Saudi Arabia)

OTHER ROLES

Account Manager – Acumed Diagnostic Centre, Ghana (2010–2013)

Internal Auditor – Central Medical Store, Ghana (2009–2010)

EDUCATION & QUALIFICATIONS

ACCA (UK) – Member since 2017

MSc Financial Mathematics, University of Leeds – 2008

BSc Physics & Computer Science, University of Ghana – 2005

Training & Certifications: PCAOB - IFRS 17 Transition - Solvency II Reporting